Capacity Check

If a blocker or appointment already exists, you can only block the remaining capacity, not the maximum capacity. The capacity to be blocked must always be less than or equal to the maximum capacity of the loading point validity period. If a new blocker exceeds the maximum capacity, it cannot be created. To resolve this, you can either reduce the capacity of the blocker or cancel existing blockers or appointments.

Releasing a Time Block

If the docking locations that share the loading point are in the same tenant, then the user can release the block.

If the docking locations that share the loading point are in different tenants, then only the user who created the time block can release the same.

Viewing a Loading Point

Loading point settings provide detailed information about the configuration and status of loading points, including capacity and time slots.

To view the loading point settings, proceed as follows:

1. Choose the **Loading Point** tab on the left pane.
2. Enter the loading point ID in the search bar on the left pane to search for a specific loading point.
3. Choose a loading point from the results.

   The system displays the detail view of the settings on a right pane.

The detail view consists of a header and other sections.

Header

The header section displays the following information:

- **Loading Point ID**
- **Shared**

  Displays **Shared** when this loading point has enabled sharing with multiple docking locations
- **Loading Point Icon**

  Displays the loading point icon.

  Also displays a shared sign on this icon when a loading point has enabled sharing with business partners. You can view the sharing details by choosing this icon. The system displays the **Loading Point ID**, **Location ID**, **Shared By**, and **Permissions**.
- **Location ID**
- **Capacity**

  Displays the number of loading/unloading activities that can be performed concurrently at the loading point
- **Status**

  Displays one of the following statuses:

  - **Draft**

This status appears after you create a loading point and choose the **Save** button. You can delete a loading point only when it is in a draft status.

- **Active**

  This status appears when you activate a draft or an inactive loading point or when you choose the **Save and Activate** button while creating a new loading point.

- **Inactive**

  This status appears when you deactivate a loading point by choosing the **Deactivate** button. Note that deactivation may take some time and you may have to refresh your page to get the updated status. You cannot deactivate a loading point that has any reservations or future appointments.

- **Decommissioned**

  This status appears when you close a loading point by choosing the **Decommission** button. You can only decommission loading points that are in the inactive status. Once you decommission a loading point, you cannot activate or perform any actions.

Details

The Details section displays the following information:

- **Loading Point ID**

  The loading point ID is the identification of a single loading point for differentiation. A loading point can have several areas (for example, doors), which are represented by the capacity.

- **Location ID**

  The location ID is composed of the source system and the external ID as follows: *<Source System>:<External ID>*. It is retrieved from the location master data one time at the beginning. After activation it cannot be changed anymore even if the values in the **Manage Locations** app change.

  > **Note**
  > The location ID of the loading point is not used to determine the loading point of the appointment. Instead, the location ID of the docking location is used to determine the docking location for appointment booking.

- **Description**

  Displays the location description. The system retrieves this information once from the master data of the associated location when the location has been assigned to the loading point.

- **Address**

  Displays the location address. The system retrieves this information once from the master data of the associated location when the location has been assigned to the loading point.

- **Capacity**

  Displays the number of loading/unloading activities that can be performed concurrently at the loading point.

  In a logistics setting, a capacity value of 10 typically indicates that there are 10 doors available in the loading area, allowing 10 trucks to be loaded or unloaded simultaneously. However, the exact meaning of capacity depends on how your operational entities – such as loading points and docks – are defined and modeled within your system. For instance, if each door is represented as a loading point in your configuration, then the capacity assigned to each loading point is 1.

- **Activity Type**

  Displays whether you can perform loading, unloading, or both activities in that loading point.

- **Time Zone**

  Displays the time zone of the location. The system retrieves this information once from the master data of the associated location when the location has been assigned to the loading point.

- **Appointment Date Change**

  Indicates whether a carrier can change the date of a dock appointment within a range that you specify. If this setting is enabled, you can view the following fields:

  - **Advance Up To**

    Displays the number of days up to which the carrier can advance the dock appointment date.

  - **Postpone Up To**

    Displays the number of days up to which the carrier can postpone the dock appointment date.

- **Time Slot Booking**

  Displays whether time slot booking is enabled for a loading point. When you enable this setting, the system displays the following defined time slot duration:

  - **Time Slot Duration**

    Displays the time duration at the loading point level for a single bookable time slot, starting from the hours of operation defined in your validity period.

  - **Restrict Maximum Duration of Consecutive Time Slots**

    Displays whether the maximum duration of all consecutive time slots is restricted. This setting ensures that the sum of time slots to be booked by your carrier cannot exceed the maximum consecutive duration of all adjacent time slots. This restriction only affects the booking for the carrier when they select more than one time slot. They can always book at least one time slot. As the shipper, you can always exceed the maximum duration.

    For more information, see the following blog: SAP Business Network for Logistics - Dock Appointment Scheduling: Max. Consecutive Timeslot Duration.

  - **Maximum Consecutive Duration**

    Displays the maximum duration of all adjacent time slots.

  - **Use Derived Appointment Duration**

    If you enable the **Use Derived Appointment Duration** toggle, the system forces carrier users to book appointment durations based on input from an external system.

    This can, for example, come from the `TransportationOrderRequest` message type in SAP Transportation Management or transportation management (TM) in SAP S/4HANA, using the `RequestedLoadingDateTimePeriod` and/or `RequestedUnloadingDateTimePeriod` fields.

    Another option is through the *Provider API for Dock Appointment Scheduling* (`GenericAppointment_In`), using the `RequestedStartDateTime` and `RequestedEndDateTime` fields.

    For more information about the setup and the underlying processes, see the following blog: SAP Business Network for Logistics - Dock Appointment Scheduling: Use Derived Appointment Duration.

  - **Capacity and Time Slot At**

    Displays the level at which you have enabled the capacity and time slot settings.

- **Overbooking**

  Displays whether you have enabled overbooking for the loading point. If you have enabled this setting, the system displays the following:

- **Overbooking Limit**

  Displays the overbooking limit. Overbooking limit refers to the number of appointments that can be booked once the available slots are booked, with a maximum 50.

- **Overbooking for Carriers**

  Displays whether you have enabled overbooking for carriers for this loading point.

- **Enable Assignment**

  - **Assignment with Docking Locations**

    Displays whether you have enabled this loading point to be assigned with multiple docking locations in the same time zone. If you disable this setting, the loading point can be associated with only one docking location in the same time zone.

  - **Assigned Docking Locations**

    Displays the docking locations in the same time zone with which you want to share the loading point.

- **Remarks**

  Displays additional information about the loading point in this section.

Share Entity

You can share the loading point details with your business partner. Based on the settings you provide here, the business partner can either view or view and edit the loading point details.

This section displays the following information:

- **Created By**

  Displays the details of who created the loading point sharing.

- **Share Entity With**

  Displays the business partners with whom the loading point has been shared with.

- **Permissions**

  Displays whether the business partner can only view or edit the loading point settings.

ℹ Note

You can only share active loading points with your business partners. That is, when you create a loading point, save, and activate the setting, you can edit the loading point settings and add sharing details.

As a prerequisite, you must establish a relationship with the business partner (shipper) with whom you want to share your loading point. To do so, use the **Invite Business Partners** app and add a new invitee as a shipper. The shipper must operate in the same data center as you. For more information, see Add New Business Partners.

Validity Period

This section displays the validity period of the loading point. This section displays the following information:

- **Period**

  Displays the duration for which the entry of validity period is valid.

- **Working Days**

  Displays the working days of the loading point.

  Working Hours

  Displays the working hours for the specified working days.

- **Maximum Capacity**

  Displays the maximum capacity for a specific period or working hours.

Block Time

The system displays the following information:

- **Description**

  Displays the description for the time block.

- **Disable Appointment Booking**

  Displays whether you have disabled appointment booking only for the carriers or for all.

- **Start Date and Time**

  Displays the start date and time of the blocked time.

- **End Date and Time**

  Displays the end date and time of the blocked time.

- **Capacity**

  Displays the capacity of the blocked time.

- **Max. Capacity**

  When the **Max. Capacity** toggle is enabled, the maximum capacity is blocked for this loading point, and the capacity in the dropdown above is disabled because it is no longer relevant.

  For more information, see the following blog: SAP Business Network for Logistics - Dock Appointment Scheduling: Maximum Capacity Blocker.

- **Including Overbooking**

  When the **Include Overbooking** toggle is enabled, the capacity maintained under **Overbooking Limit** is blocked for this loading point.

- **Recurrence**

  For recurring blocks, you can see the recurrence interval (daily, weekly or monthly) and the recurrence end date.

  For more information, see the following blog: SAP Business Network for Logistics - Dock Appointment Scheduling: Announcing Recurring Block Times.

- **View History**

  If this toggle is enabled, the system also displays the appointments that are in the past. By default, time blocks in the past are hidden.

Note

The minimum duration when adding a block is 5 minutes, and the maximum duration is 31 days.

If you want to block your loading point for more than 31 days, you can use the **Deactivate** option of the loading point. For more information, see the status **Inactive** under **Header** on this page.

Uploading and Downloading Loading Points

SAP Business Network Freight Collaboration enables you to simplify the entity management process especially when you have lot of entities to be processed.

You can view, edit, and upload entities using a Microsoft Excel file. This feature enables you to work on multiple entries simultaneously thereby saving a lot of time. You can download and upload the entities in Microsoft Excel format.

In the **Loading Point** tab, in the worklist area on the left, you can view the **Excel** button. When you choose this button, you can select one of the following options:

- **Download**

  You can download all the loading point entities in Microsoft Excel.

- **Upload**

  You can upload the edited Microsoft Excel template containing the loading points that you want to add.

  > **Note**
  > This only works if you have selected the **Loading Point Level** value under **Capacity and Time Slot At**. The upload does not support the **Validity Period Level** and **Working Hours Level** features.
  >
  > You cannot import or export recurring blocks to or from Microsoft Excel.

- **Export Template**

  You can download this Microsoft Excel template file to add the loading points and upload it in the system.

Download Loading Points Microsoft Excel

The downloaded loading points Microsoft Excel file contains the following worksheets:

- **Loading Points**

  This worksheet contains all the information in the loading point **Details** tab in the **Manage Entities** app. You can view the following columns:

  - Loading Point Reference

    As the loading point information has been split across different worksheets in this Microsoft Excel file, the system has created this reference ID in the Microsoft Excel file. When you switch to another worksheet, you can use this reference ID to logically map the relevant data.

  - Name
  - Location ID
  - Capacity
  - Time Slot Booking
  - Time Slot Duration
  - Restrict Maximum Duration of Consecutive Time Slots

- Maximum Consecutive Duration
- Use Derived Appointment Duration
- Activity Type
- Appointment Date Change (In this loading point)
- Advance Up To
- Postpone Up To
- Overbooking
- Overbooking Limit
- Time Zone

ℹ Note

For loading point entities in draft status, you can edit all the above fields.

For loading point entities in active and inactive statuses, you can edit the **Appointment Date Change (In this loading point)**, **Advance Up To**, **Postpone Up To**, **Overbooking**, and **Overbooking Limit** fields. All the other fields are non-editable similar to the edit option in loading points in the **Manage Entities** app.

- Business Working Hours

  This worksheet contains all the information in the **Business Hours** tab in the **Manage Entities** app. You can view the following columns:

  - Loading point reference
  - Time period reference
  - Start date
  - End date
  - Working days
  - Start time
  - End time

  Note that you can edit all the fields in this worksheet similar to the edit option in loading points in the **Manage Entities** app.

- Reservations

  This worksheet contains all the information in the **Block Time** tab in the **Manage Entities** app. You can view the following columns:

  - Loading point reference
  - Description
  - Category
  - Capacity
  - Max. Capacity
  - Include Overbooking
  - Start date
  - Start time

- End date
- End time

Note that you can edit all the fields except for the **Category** and **Capacity** in this worksheet similar to the edit option in loading points in the **Manage Entities** app.

Upload Loading Points Microsoft Excel

To upload the loading points in a Microsoft Excel file, perform the following:

1. You can use the loading points file that you previously downloaded using the **Download** option to edit the existing data.

   Alternatively, you can download the template by choosing **Loading Point** > **Excel** > **Export Template** option to add new loading points. This template contains the same worksheets and columns similar to the downloaded loading points Microsoft Excel file. However, it does not contain any data.

   Note that you can only use either the template or the downloaded file to upload into the system.

2. Upload the Excel file by choosing **Loading Point** > **Excel** > **Upload**.

   Upload entities dialog box appears.

3. Select the edited file that you want to upload from your computer and choose Proceed.

   The system displays the confirmation message indicating the number of loading point entities that will be uploaded. It will also display the error log if some of the entities are in error state. You can download the error log to investigate the issue.

4. Choose **Confirm** to upload the entities.

   Displays whether the entities are uploaded. If they are uploaded, you can view them in the **Loading Point** tab in the app.

ℹ Note

There are a few columns that are hidden in the worksheets. These columns contain technical information. You cannot edit these columns

Adding of **Enable Sharing** option is currently not available in the Microsoft Excel file.

You cannot edit the status of the loading point in the Microsoft Excel file. You can only change the status in the **Manage Entities** app.

You can only upload Microsoft Excel files with a maximum of 2500 entries.

Defining Docking Location Settings

To define the settings for a docking location, proceed as follows:

1. Choose the **Docking Location** tab on the left pane.
2. Choose the **Add Docking Location** button.

   The create docking location pane appears on the right.

3. Define settings for the following sections:
   - **Details**
   - **Business Hours**

- Loading Points

4. Choose **Save** to save the docking location as a draft. Choose **Save and Activate** to activate the docking location settings.

ℹ Note

The following fields cannot be changed any longer after the docking location was activated:

- Docking Location ID
- Location ID
- Description
- Address
- Time Zone

Details

Enter the following information in the details section:

- **Docking Location ID** (mandatory)

  Enter a docking location ID.

- **Location ID** (mandatory)

  Select a location ID.

  You maintain location master data in the **Manage Locations** app. The location ID is composed of the source system and the external ID as follows: *<Source System>:<External ID>*. It is retrieved from the location master data once when the docking location is created. After activation it cannot be changed anymore even if the values in the **Manage Locations** app change.

  The location ID is used to determine the docking location for the appointment. You can select one of the assigned loading points of the docking location for the appointment booking.

  ### ℹ Note

  If the appointment is created from a freight order, the location ID of the docking location is composed from the `SenderBusinessSystemID` field in the *Provider API to Create Freight Order for Subcontracting* (`TransportationOrderRequest_Out`) and from the loading or unloading location `InternalId` field under the `TransportationStage` node.

  The location ID of the loading point is not considered for the determination of the loading point if the appointment is created with the *Provider API to Create a Freight Order for Subcontracting*.

  If the appointment is created through the *Provider API for Dock Appointment Scheduling* (`GenericAppointment_In`), the docking location ID is sent through the `DockingLocationId` API field. A confirmed appointment for a dedicated loading point can be booked by additionally sending the `LoadingPointId` API field. You can also fix the loading point by sending the `LoadingPointId` API field. Then, this loading point will be preselected on the UI, and you cannot change it. This is only supported with *GenericAppointment_In* and not with *TransportationOrderRequest_Out*.

- **Time Zone**

  Enter a time zone.

- **Cut-Off Time for Appointment Creation**

  You can choose whether you want to enable or disable the cut-off time for appointment creation for carriers. When you enable this setting, the system displays the **Cut-Off Days and Time** fields. You can enter the number of days and time before which all

loading points at this docking location must stop accepting dock appointments from carriers. Note that the cut-off time is not applicable for warehouse operators and that a date change is only possible before the cut-off time.

- **Appointment Date Change**

  When you enable this setting, carriers can change the date of a dock appointment. A date change is possible only before the cut-off time.

  > **Note**
  > You must also enable the**Appointment Date Change** setting on the corresponding loading point to allow date changes.

- **Remarks**

  You can enter the additional information about the docking location.

Business Hours

Choose the add icon in this section to add an entry of business hours.

> **Note**
> As of now, you can only add one entry of business hours.

Enter the following information:

- **Period**

  Specify the duration for which the entry of business hours is valid.

- **Working Days**

  Specify the working days of the docking location.

- **Working Hours**

  Specify the working hours for the specified working days.

  To add another entry of validity period, choose the add icon. You can create up to 10 entries per validity period.

Loading Points

Choose the add icon in this section to add a loading point to the docking location. The system displays the list of active loading points in the same time zone that you have maintained in the **Manage Entities** app. You can select the loading points that you want to add to the docking location.

> **Note**
> The system displays active loading points in the same time zone that are either shared with this docking location or active loading points that are yet to be associated with any docking location.

Viewing a Docking Location

Docking location settings provide detailed information about the docking location itself and all loading points in the docking location.

To view the docking location settings, proceed as follows: